

Troubleshooting your hardware

- ◆ Check if the power supply is ON and connected properly.
- ◆ Check if all pins have been connected properly.
- ◆ Check for any hot components. If there are any, chances are that the component is damaged.
- ◆ If the PCB gets hot, then you have a faulty PCB with a short circuit. You'll need to get a newer one.
- ◆ Use a continuity tester to check for faulty connection.

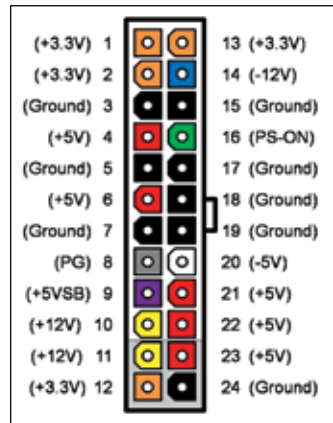


ATX power connector

Using a computer power supply

It's usually difficult to get a power supply adapter with the required rating. In such cases, the SMPS (Switching Mode Power Supply), i.e. your desktop computer's power supply, can be used to supply the necessary power. We'll use the ATX power connector pin that's connected to the motherboard of your desktop computer.

The picture shows a 24-pin version ATX power connectors. The details of voltage output at various pins are shown in the pin diagram below. To start the SMPS, we need to short circuit the terminals shown in black (COM) and green (PS_ON).



24 pin ATX power connector

To conclude...

This chapter familiarises you with the various jargon used in the world of electronics. We looked at ways to troubleshoot a problem in case you encounter one. Finally, we looked at a way by which you could use your computer's power supply to provide the necessary juice to run your project.

Armed with this knowledge, hope you develop something of your own and make a splash in the Internet of Things domain. Do share your projects with us at editor@digit.in. 